



1ST WEEK: **DAY 3**

Going home

YOUR BABY TODAY

A new baby's skin is often quite dry in the first few weeks. This is normal, and the skin will eventually correct itself. Although you don't need to put moisturizer on a baby's skin, if you want you could gently massage in some baby or olive oil.

“ Once your breast milk arrives, your baby may start to appear more relaxed and contented and go longer between feedings ”

You'll likely head home from the hospital today. The doctor will do a checkup before you go home to make sure the uterus has contracted and your blood loss (lochia) isn't too heavy. Any stitches or staples will likely be removed before you're discharged, although many doctors now use subcuticular stitches (just under the skin layer) that gradually absorb over a few weeks.

Your first day at home with your new baby can be daunting. Keeping your baby's crib close to your bed can make life easier when you feed or change them at night. Keep lights low and don't talk much or stimulate your baby. Only change their diaper if necessary, and once the feeding is done, put them right back in their crib.

You'll discover that babies don't like having clothes pulled over their head. Keep life simple by buying machine-washable, front-fastening onesies and change outfits only as needed. In the first weeks, there is no need to change into a daytime outfit. If your baby is cold, simply add layers.

Today, you may notice that the swelling in your hands and feet subsides as you urinate more. You still need to drink plenty of fluids to prevent bladder infections, avoid constipation, and help breast milk production. Today may be the first time you move your bowels since giving birth. Eating plenty of fruit, vegetables, and whole grain products and drinking water will help your bowel movements return to normal.

Partners will be proud to have the baby at home. They can be involved in most all aspects of care, including calming the baby, changing diapers, bottle-feeding, bathing, and dressing.

SPONGE BATHS

Babies need only two or three baths a week. Before the umbilical cord stump falls off, give sponge baths. Wrap your baby in a towel and lie them on a flat surface. Get ready a baby washcloth, a bowl of warm water, and mild baby soap. Uncover only the parts you're actively